

Philipp Hilbert. *Operational product owner for complex technical software.*

Positioning, nearly ten years translating complex operational workflows into dev-ready requirements, now applying that to PBX and VoIP product delivery.

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§ WHY STARFACE

Starface occupies a technically demanding niche – Linux-based PBX systems delivered across cloud, hardware appliance, and VM – where the product owner must hold both the business logic and the infrastructure constraints in mind simultaneously. The job description explicitly asks for someone who can bridge development and business units while keeping backlog quality high under delivery pressure; that is precisely the operating mode I have practiced across defence, InsurTech, and public analytics programmes. The combination of on-prem and cloud deployment variants mirrors the hybrid complexity I managed at Rohde & Schwarz and Emil Group, where requirements had to account for fundamentally different runtime environments. *That intersection of operational depth and cross-functional clarity is where I am most effective.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not shipped a PBX or VoIP product directly; my telephony-adjacent experience is limited to protocol-level familiarity rather than SIP stack ownership. What I do bring is a strong track record of rapidly internalising complex technical domains – AI data platforms, InsurTech policy engines, public-sector analytics – and translating them into well-structured backlogs within the first weeks of engagement.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements drafting and edge-case generation
- **GPT**, stakeholder communication and spec review
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo assistance during implementation support
- **Cursor / VSCode**, code-level product investigation
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Gamma.app**, structured presentation of product concepts
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Framer**, design-heavy mockups and concept work

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Across production roles: Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Django, AngularJS, Ionic, REST APIs, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, OpenShift, Argo Workflows, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git, Redpanda, MicroStrategy, low-code insurance platform. Comfortable reading and navigating codebases to assess feasibility independently.

§ SIDE PROJECT

QCRYPT AG [YOUTUBE.COM/WATCH?V=NT06F71LGFE](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NT06F71LGFE) →

Quantum-secure encryption product built on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware.

- Owned the full product architecture for backup, restore, checkpoint, and data-encryption flows.
- One-time-pad approach with true-RNG hardware; setup designed to require under two minutes with no technical knowledge from the end user.
- Served concurrently as deputy IT security officer, covering attack-vector assessment and compliance posture.
- Directly relevant for Starface's on-prem and hybrid deployment scenarios where data security and operational simplicity must coexist.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT STARFACE

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Audit the existing backlog for the PBX cloud, on-prem, and hybrid tracks – identify where acceptance criteria are missing, where bugs and tech debt are unpriced, and where the distinction between product management vision and operational implementation has become blurred.

WEEK 2

Sharpen and slice.

Rework the top of the backlog into properly sized, independently testable user stories with clear acceptance criteria, and run a first structured refinement session with the dev team to calibrate shared understanding.

WEEK 3+

Close delivery loops.

Establish a steady cadence of sprint planning, review, and retrospective; coordinate active bugs and support escalations with QA and operations; and make backlog status continuously visible to all stakeholders.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Starface hiring team,

I am applying for the Product Owner PBX Software role. My background is nearly ten years of hands-on product ownership across technically complex, operationally intensive software systems – AI data platforms for European defence programmes, InsurTech SaaS serving primary insurers and reinsurers, public-sector analytics infrastructure, and a quantum-encryption startup I co-founded. The common thread is translating ambiguous, high-stakes requirements into structured backlogs that development teams can actually execute against.

The challenge your job description centres on – owning the operative delivery of PBX products across cloud, on-prem, and hybrid deployment variants while keeping requirements quality high and communication transparent – matches the operating mode I have maintained across my last three engagements. At Emil Group I inherited a 17-person team in a prototype-stage

environment with eroded sprint discipline and near-total senior developer attrition. I split the team into smaller Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices, rebuilt the client relationship through weekly product workshops, and stabilised delivery within two months. At Rohde & Schwarz I delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end – user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout – in a programme with multinational stakeholders and strict data provenance requirements. Both situations demanded exactly what your posting describes: strong backlog ownership, clear prioritisation across value, stability, and technical feasibility, and reliable communication between development and business units.

I do not have a direct PBX or VoIP background, and I want to name that honestly. What I have demonstrated repeatedly is the ability to internalize a new technical domain quickly and contribute meaningfully within weeks rather than months. The Linux-based, multi-deployment-model architecture that defines your product portfolio is conceptually close to the Kubernetes-based, multi-environment systems I have managed; the product ownership mechanics – understanding deployment constraints, balancing feature work against operational stability, coordinating with support and QA on live issues – transfer directly.

My working language preferences align well with your requirements. German is my native language; I communicate at C2 level in English and am comfortable in mixed-language technical environments. I am based in Berlin and open to discussing on-site arrangements in Karlsruhe.

I would welcome a conversation about the current state of the backlog and where the most immediate gaps are. That is usually the fastest way for both sides to assess fit.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Owner and Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience owning delivery for complex, technically demanding software systems across SaaS, regulated environments, and infrastructure-heavy programmes. Comfortable operating where requirements are incomplete, deployment environments are heterogeneous, and teams need a clear, decisive product owner to maintain sprint discipline and backlog quality. Experienced in cross-functional coordination across development, QA, operations, and external stakeholders. Technically fluent enough to assess feasibility independently and communicate constraints without translation loss.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Backlog ownership and prioritisation under delivery pressure
- Requirements engineering: epics, user stories, acceptance criteria
- Cross-functional alignment across development, QA, support, and operations
- Restoring sprint discipline in disrupted or growing teams
- Technical feasibility assessment without engineering dependence
- Multi-environment product understanding: cloud, on-prem, hybrid
- Stakeholder communication, transparent and structured
- Rapid domain internalisation in unfamiliar technical verticals
- Founder-level pragmatism and ownership, low ego

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout
- Led cross-functional team of architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA across multinational stakeholder landscape
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; delivered in one week a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year
- Responsible for data transformation, transparency, and auditability with full data provenance and audit trails

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Delivered new features for the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform: labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, modernised admin tooling
- Standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time; migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage

- Coordinated across engineering, data science, and public-sector stakeholders under governance constraints

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Re-established sprint discipline and delivery stability; split a bloated 17-person team into smaller, effective Scrum units with clear ownership and deputy concepts
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices that had been lost under delivery pressure
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core patient-facing flows: digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and document storage across iOS and Android
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows under strict legacy API constraints
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity
- Maintained delivery focus under tight deadlines by applying strict highest-leverage prioritisation

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner, Quantum-Secure Encryption

- Owned product architecture for backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption flows; designed for setup under two minutes with no technical knowledge required
- Served concurrently as deputy IT security officer covering attack-vector assessment and compliance posture

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Built a group-based P2P payment product on a P2P backbone; owned PSP integration, full UX/UI design, and mobile app prototype

- Product later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

PROXY PRODUCT OWNER – AOK HEALTH INSURANCE ITSCARE 2019, 2020

- Migrated internal webshop to Shopware including complex catalogue and API integration and configurable approval policies

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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